

Scar Care following Minor Surgery treatment.

If you have any concerns, please contact us via email in the first instance - on sageaesthetic@me.com, and we will contact you as soon as possible (usually within a couple of hours) to arrange a time for you to be reviewed in the clinic. Please remember to include a telephone number so that we can contact you. Alternatively the main clinic number is 07885 75 74 73 but it is not monitored at all times

What is a scar?

Scars are collagen fibres produced as a result of the body's normal healing process. The amount of scar tissue produced by the body varies depending on the individual and type of surgery / injury.

Why is it important to care for your scar?

Initially scars can be firm, thick and red in colour (active phase) but over time soften and become pale in colour (matured). This whole process may take 12 to 18 months or more.

During the 'active phase' you can use massage to help your skin scar well. Initially as scar tissue forms it is firm and tacky and can stick to structures around it; scar care helps to flatten, make it softer and reduces the chance of scar tissue sticking (adhesions).

Other scar treatments

Other scar treatments include vibration massage and silicone based products (such as gel, gel sheets or elastomer putty). If you are regular and firm with your own scar massage this are less likely to be needed.

Scar massage

When to start? 24 - 48 hours **after** your stitches have been removed, as long as the wound is dry.

What do I need?

You will need a basic, un-perfumed moisturising cream. For example, aqueous cream is ideal for massaging scars. Expensive oils are not needed, but will not cause harm.

Method

The scar massage needs to be in **circular movements**, on and around the scar line, to keep the skin moving freely.

In the first few days you may only tolerate gentle massage but you should then aim to increase to **deep, firm massage** to reduce the risk of adhesions. Sensitivity in a new scar is completely normal, but will be helped by massage as the fibres flatten and organise.

Scar massage: Start date: _ _ _ _ _

Repeat daily - try to develop a habit of massaging your scar for ten minutes or so when you are relaxing in the evening for example.

Any other advice to care for your wound:

Please remember - we are very happy to answer any queries you might have, or see you to reassess if you have any concerns, feel free to contact us as noted above.

